November 2026

CLAYTON ADAMSON

University of Wisconsin-Madison | Department of Sociology | Center for Demography and Ecology
ClaytonAdamson.com | cadamson@wisc.edu

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social stratification ◇ Economic growth and development ◇ Demography
Migration ◇ Spatial methods ◇ Place

EDUCATION

In progress **University of Wisconsin–Madison**, Ph.D. in Sociology
- *Preliminary Exams*: demography; social stratification
- *Minor*: Community Development & Family Policy
- *Committee*: Katherine J. Curtis; Christine Schwartz; Max Besbris; Megan Doherty Bea; Anton Babkin

2022 **Cornell University**, M.S. in Regional Science

2019 **University of Minnesota-Twin Cities**, B.S.B. in Accounting; B.S.B. in Finance

RESEARCH ACTIVITY

Published & Forthcoming

Clayton Adamson. (forthcoming). "Growth Without Gain: The Adverse Effects of State and Local Development Incentives on Resident Prosperity." *Urban Affairs Review*. Link to preprint.

Clayton Adamson. (2026). "Unequal Returns to Growth and Decline Across U.S. Regions and Social Classes." *Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy, and Society*. Link to preprint / full text.

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. (2026). "The Intergenerational Mobility Advantage of Educators' Children: Capital Embedded in Occupations." *Social Science Research*. Link to full text.

Karl Vachuska and **Clayton Adamson**. (2026). "Neighborhood Shocks and Network Dynamics: An Instrumental Variable Approach to Measuring Triadic Closure in Daily Mobility Networks." *Social Networks*. Link to full text.

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Sarah Peters. (2025). "Economic Complexity and Divergent Population Growth by Race and Rurality." *Spatial Demography*, 13(1), 5. Link to full text.

Under Review

***** *denotes equal authorship*

Clayton Adamson. "Uneven Jobs, Uneven Places: Industrial Structure and the Geography of Job Quality" (conditional acceptance at *Population Research and Policy Review*)

Clayton Adamson. "State-Subsidized Development and Rural Population Change: Migrant Attraction or In-State Reshuffling?" (abstract accepted, invited submission at *Rural Sociology*)

Clayton Adamson. "A Century of Hidden Harm: Alcohol Exposure and Intergenerational Status Attainment" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. "Cost-of-Living Inequality Sustains Racial Earnings Inequality in the United States" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Katherine J. Curtis. "Who Still Benefits from Moving? Declining and Unequal Returns to Internal Migration" (under review)

Clayton Adamson and Megan Doherty Bea. "Indebted from the Start: Childcare Costs and Family Financial Trajectories" (under review)

***Clayton Adamson** and *****Karl Vachuska. "Expected Years of Homeownership Are Declining for Americans without a BA" (under review)

Megan Doherty Bea**, Clayton Adamson**, Max Besbris, and Youngmin Yi. "Exposure to Disasters over the Life Course in the United States" (under review)

Nicholas D.E. Mark**, Clayton Adamson**, and Max Besbris. "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era" (under review)

Katherine J. Curtis, Sara A. Peters, **Clayton Adamson**, Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, and Richard A. Dunn. "Economic Structure and the Rural Mortality Penalty: A Spatial Regime Analysis" (under review)

Karl Vachuska, **Clayton Adamson**, Brian Levy, and Max Besbris. "Neighborhoods, Homicide, and Racial Inequality in Life Expectancy: The Impact of Residence and Routine Mobility" (under review)

Technical Reports & Extension

Katherine J. Curtis, Raevan Faye Chandler, **Clayton Adamson,** and Sara A. Peters. "Wisconsin County Migration Trends." *Applied Population Lab*, University of Wisconsin–Madison Extension, November 2025.

Refereed Conference Presentations

Clayton Adamson and Karl Vachuska. "Cost-of-Living Inequality Sustains Racial Earnings Inequality in the United States." *Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Spring Meeting 2026, Seville, Spain*.

Clayton Adamson. "Occupations Revisited: How Non-Wage Parental Job Characteristics Shape Children's Attainment." *European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR) Mechanisms of Social Mobility conference, 2026, Zurich, Switzerland*.

Clayton Adamson, and Katherine J. Curtis. "The End of the Migration Premium? Unequal and Declining Returns to Internal Migration in the US." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO*.

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, and Richard A. Dunn. "Rethinking Rural Disadvantage: Economic, Not Geographic, Isolation Patterns Local Social Exclusion." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO*.

Nicholas D.E. Mark, **Clayton Adamson**, and Max Besbris. "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO*.

Sara Peters, **Clayton Adamson**, and Michael Topping. "The Changing Value of Education in U.S. Mortality Trends." *Population Association of America, 2026, St. Louis, MO*.

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, and Richard A. Dunn. "Using network theory to characterize economic, geographic, and social dimensions of isolation." *72nd Annual North American Meetings of the Regional Science Association International, 2025, Denver, CO.*

Sara Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Michael Topping, and Anton Babkin. "Structural Dimensions of Rising Premature Mortality in US: Examining the Role of Economy, Race, and Rurality." *American Sociological Society Annual Meeting, 2025, Chicago, IL.*

Clayton Adamson. "Higher Tech, Lower Opportunity: Regressive Impact of Local Tech Sector on Intergenerational Mobility." *Research Committee 28 on Social Stratification and Mobility (RC28) Summer Meeting 2025, Los Angeles, CA*.

Clayton Adamson, Sarah Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, and Richard A. Dunn. "Unequal distribution of benefits of regional trade using quantile and spatial modeling." *Rural Sociology Society Annual Meeting, 2024, Madison, WI*.

Sarah Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Anton Babkin, Richard A. Dunn, and Austin Sandler. "Industry and the Rural Mortality Penalty: A Spatial Regime Analysis of Economic Structure and Early Life Mortality in the Rural U.S." *Rural Sociology Society Annual Meeting, 2024, Madison, WI*.

Dunn, Richard A., Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "The Spatial Structure of Economic Exchange and Rural Prosperity in the United States." *Agricultural and Applied Economics Annual Meeting, 2024, New Orleans, LA*.

Dunn, Richard A., Anton Babkin, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "Economic Catchment Areas: A New Place Typology Based on Supply Chain Connectedness." *Agricultural and Applied Economics Annual Meeting, 2024, New Orleans, LA*.

Clayton Adamson, Katherine J. Curtis and Sarah Peters. "Economic complexity and regional and racial variation in population growth in the metropolitan and nonmetropolitan United States." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH*.

Karl Vachuska, **Clayton Adamson**, Brian Levy, and Max Besbris. "Neighborhoods, Homicide, and Racial Inequality in Life Expectancy: The Impact of Residence and Routine Mobility." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH*.

Babkin, Anton, Richard Dunn, Austin Sandler, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Sara A. Peters. "Economic Catchment Areas: A New Place Typology Based on Potential Supply Chain Connectedness." *Population Association of America, 2024, Columbus, OH*.

Conference Poster Presentations

Clayton Adamson. "Tech-sector growth, economic polarization, and intergenerational mobility: regressive consequences of contemporary growth coalitions." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Clayton Adamson, Meiyi Li, Max Besbris, and Karl Vachuska. "Lagging housing values and homeowner health: race & place." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Sara Peters, Katherine J. Curtis, **Clayton Adamson**, Michael Topping, and Anton Babkin. "Structural Dimensions of Rising Premature Mortality in the US: An Examination of the Role of the Economy, Race, and Rurality." *Population Association of America, 2025, Washington, D.C.*

Clayton Adamson, Meiyi Li, Max Besbris, and Karl Vachuska. "Lagging housing values and homeowner health: race & place." *HOME: Health, Opportunity, Mobility, and Equity in Housing, a research symposium hosted by the Minnesota Population Center (MPC), 2025, Minneapolis, MN.*

GRANTS

2026 NICHD Small Research Grant (R03) – under review October 2026 – $100,000
- *Role*: lead author
- *Co-PIs*: Katherine J. Curtis
- *Project*: "Who Still Benefits from Moving? Declining and Unequal Returns to Internal Migration"

2026 NICHD Small Research Grant (R03) – under review October 2026 – $100,000
- *Role*: lead author
- *Co-PIs*: Max Besbris, Nicholas Mark
- *Project*: "Housing Costs and US Fertility: A New Era"

2026 USDA NIFA AFRI – funded February 2026 – $650,000
- *Role*: supporting author
- *PIs*: Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin
- *Project*: "The Spatial Structure of Economic Exchange and Rural Prosperity in the United States"

TEACHING & MENTORSHIP

Instructor on Record – "Poverty and Place"
- Community and Environmental Sociology 578
- Spring 2027

Graduate Student Mentor
- Chloe Patterson (2025-2026)
- Emma Dewil (2024-2026)

Guest Lecturer – Spatial Methods Working Group
- "Quantitative Spatial Econometrics" (Spring 2026, Fall 2024, Spring 2024)
- "Causal Inference in Spatial Methods" (Spring 2025)

SERVICE

Reviewer: *Spatial Demography; Economic Development Quarterly; Journal of Rural Health*

2026-2027 Department Hiring Committee

2026-2027 Graduate Student Professional Development & Job Search Committee

2025-2026 Department Undergraduate Curriculum Committee

2025 Co-Facilitator, Spatial Methods Working Group

EMPLOYMENT

2023-present **University of Wisconsin-Madison**, Center for Demography and Ecology
Predoctoral Research Fellow (Katherine J. Curtis)
Research Assistant (Katherine J. Curtis, Anton Babkin, Max Besbris, Nicholas D.E. Mark, Megan Doherty Bea)
Madison, Wisconsin

2024-2026 **Land Strategies**
Director of Economic Modeling and Analytics (part-time)
Greenville, South Carolina

2023-2026 **Minneapolis-Saint Paul Economic Development Partnership**
Research Manager (part-time)
Saint Paul, Minnesota

2022-2023 Research Manager (full-time)
Saint Paul, Minnesota

2022 **The Brookings Institution**, Workforce of the Future initiative
Research Assistant
Washington, D.C.

2019-2021 **Grant Thornton LLP**
Economic Development Incentives Consultant
Minneapolis, Minnesota

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

Fellowships

2025-2026 Evelyn T. Crowe Fellowship from the Department of Community and Environmental Sociology at the University of Wisconsin–Madison

2023-2026 T32 pre-doctoral training grant (T32 HD07014) from the Eunice Kennedy Shriver National Institute of Child Health and Human Development (NICHD)

Professional Distinctions

2019-present Certified Public Accountant (inactive), State of Minnesota

Awards

2026 Travel Award, European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR)

2019 Summa Cum Laude undergraduate thesis, University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

2019 Magna Cum Laude graduate, University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

SKILLS

R (tidyverse, ipumsr, Leaflet, Rmarkdown), Input-Output, Python, ArcGIS, SQL, Overleaf, Geoda, Excel VBA